

DANCEFLOW

ARIA Operations Quick Start Guide

A simple first-time setup for studio owners and managers

Start small.

You do not need to configure every card, policy, and automation on day one. This guide gives you a safe starter setup that keeps ARIA useful without making your workflow feel complicated.

Estimated setup time: 10–15 minutes

Recommended for: first-time ARIA Operations users

1. What ARIA Operations Does

ARIA Operations watches the studio data already inside DanceFlow and turns important signals into clear, reviewable actions. **It does not replace your judgment.** It helps you notice what may otherwise be missed.

ARIA may surface items such as:

- A booking request that has been waiting too long.
- A student with no future lesson scheduled.
- A package that is nearly empty or expiring.
- A membership that is past due or set to cancel.
- A payment exception that needs staff review.
- An organizer event with unpaid registrations, missing costs, or a loss.

The easiest way to think about it

ARIA Operations is a smart daily work list. It helps answer: What needs attention, who owns it, and what should happen next?

What ARIA will not do automatically

- Charge, refund, retry, or clear payments.
- Approve or decline booking requests.
- Change membership terms or package balances.
- Edit accounting records or event financials.
- Make high-risk decisions without staff review.

2. How ARIA Operations and Automations Work Together

ARIA Operations and the **Automations page** are related, but they control different workflows.

Area	What it controls	Best first-week approach
ARIA Operations	Current business signals, staff ownership, approval policies, digests, and supported ARIA follow-up execution.	Use Manual review and one morning digest.
Automations	Recurring studio rules, message templates, draft creation, and optional auto-send for enabled rules.	Leave rules off, or use Suggestion/Draft mode only.
Automation Drafts	Messages created by Automations that staff can review, edit, and queue.	Review drafts before sending.

ARIA has its own automation path

When an ARIA policy is set to Auto-approve, supported ARIA actions can be approved and queued automatically by the scheduled ARIA Operations process. **The separate Automations page is not required for that ARIA workflow.**

Use the Automations page when you want recurring rules such as package-balance follow-up, no-upcoming-lesson reminders, unsigned-document reminders, aging booking requests, or first-lesson follow-up. Start those rules in Suggestion or Draft mode until the results are familiar.

Simple rule of thumb

Use ARIA Operations for the studio's current operational work list. Use Automations to configure repeatable rules and

message workflows that run over time.

3. Your Basic Starter Setup

Use the following settings for the first week. They provide useful guidance while keeping you in control.

Area	Starter setting	Why
Action policies	Manual review	ARIA creates suggestions, but a person approves them.
Default owner	Assign to the primary manager	Prevents actions from sitting unassigned.
Require assignment	Off for the first week	Keeps setup simple while you learn the workflow.
Morning digest	On at 8:00 AM	Gives you a short start-of-day summary.
End-of-day digest	Off initially	Avoids too many notifications during onboarding.
Delivery channel	Email	Makes the briefing easy to see outside the dashboard.
Auto-approval	Off initially	Lets you review ARIA's recommendations before anything is queued.

Recommended first-week rule

Review ARIA once each morning. Do not turn on auto-approval until you trust the recommendations and understand what each rule produces.

4. Set Up ARIA in 6 Steps

1 Open ARIA Operations

In DanceFlow, open ARIA and choose Operations Center.

2 Choose a default owner

Select the person who normally handles follow-up. For a small studio, this is usually the owner or front-desk manager.

3 Leave policies on Manual review

For each policy, choose Manual review. This means ARIA can recommend work, but staff decides what happens.

4 Turn on the morning digest

Enable the morning briefing, choose 8:00 AM, select Email, and choose the recipient.

5**Generate the first recommendations**

Select Generate ARIA actions. ARIA will scan current data and create reviewable items.

6**Review only the top few items**

Start with urgent and high-priority actions. Ignore lower-priority items until the basic workflow feels comfortable.

5. Your Simple Daily Routine

Morning: 5 minutes

- Read the morning digest.
- Open ARIA Operations.
- Look at Urgent and High-priority items first.
- Assign each important action to one person.
- Approve only actions you understand and want completed.

During the day

- Mark actions done after the work is completed.
- Snooze actions that are valid but not ready yet.
- Dismiss actions that are no longer relevant.
- Use Skip when the recommendation is reasonable but you intentionally do not want to act on it.

End of day: optional

Do not enable the end-of-day digest immediately. After the first week, turn it on only if the team benefits from seeing what remains open.

6. How to Handle Each Action

Button	Use it when...
Approve	You reviewed the recommendation and want it to move forward.
Assign	A specific team member should own the work.
Mark done	The task has already been completed.
Snooze	The action is valid, but should return tomorrow, in three days, or next week.
Skip	You are intentionally not acting on it this time.
Dismiss	The action is incorrect, outdated, or no longer useful.

7. What to Ignore at First

ARIA Operations and the Automations page both contain advanced options. A first-time user does not need to configure every policy, rule, template, and delivery mode.

- Do not turn on ARIA auto-approval for every policy.
- Do not enable both daily digests immediately.
- Do not try to clear every historical action on the first day.
- Do not assign different owners to every policy until the team has a stable routine.
- Do not treat every recommendation as urgent.

A healthy first-week goal

Use ARIA to identify and complete 1–3 important actions per day. Consistency matters more than clearing the entire screen.

8. Safe Starter Policies

Begin with the policies that are easiest to understand and lowest risk.

Start with	Mode	Reason
Aging booking requests	Manual review	Easy to verify and act on.
Low package balances	Manual review	Clear renewal opportunity.
Stale active students	Manual review	Useful rebooking signal.
Intro without purchase	Manual review	Clear conversion follow-up.

Keep these policies in manual review longer:

- Payment exceptions
- Past-due memberships
- Event registration payment issues
- Event losses or missing financial data

9. First-Week Checklist

- ☐ Choose one default owner.
- ☐ Keep all policies on Manual review.
- ☐ Enable only the morning email digest.
- ☐ Generate ARIA actions once.
- ☐ Open Automations and confirm that recurring rules remain Off, Suggestion, or Draft during the first week.
- ☐ Review urgent and high-priority items.
- ☐ Assign ownership before approving.
- ☐ Complete, snooze, skip, or dismiss each item you review.
- ☐ At the end of the week, decide whether any low-risk policy is ready for auto-approval.

10. When You Are Ready for More

After one week of comfortable use, expand one feature at a time:

- Turn on the end-of-day digest.
- Set different default owners for different kinds of work.
- Enable ARIA auto-approval for one supported low-risk policy.
- Use the staff ownership dashboard to balance workload.
- Review recent digest runs to confirm delivery.

Remember

ARIA is most effective when it supports an existing studio routine. Begin with a small, predictable workflow and add automation only when it clearly saves time.

DanceFlow • Helping studios turn data into clear next steps